

THE HEART OF JERIM: A critic

I genuinely liked the book — it moved me to tears at certain points especially during the deaths of close comrades and during the victories too. It also made me laugh and cringe at some moments especially at how Jerim was struck by Flower's beauty at the end. I also appreciate the emotional depth, especially centered around the theme of the heart, which gave the story a profound, almost philosophical feel.

However, from a reader's perspective, the paragraphs were often too long, which made some parts feel dense or overwhelming. This is why I chose to cut and restructure many of them into two or more segments. Since shorter paragraphs make the pacing more natural and help highlight emotional beats or dialogue more effectively without distracting the readers.

I also enjoyed the narrative style — it felt thoughtful and traditional, which suited the tone of the book well. That said, I found myself wishing for more dialogue from the characters as dialogues could really enhance the relationships and make characters' personalities stand out more vividly. As I was going through the book I found myself illustrating the characters and fully immersed in its world. I often felt like I was watching a movie in 3D.

Given that this book is part of a series, I'd recommend expanding the world-building a bit more. A map at the beginning would help orient the reader and deepen immersion. Additionally, the introductions of the characters near the end of the manuscript (those explanation-heavy parts) might be more helpful if summarized into a shorter paragraph and placed toward the beginning, right after the map. That way, readers can anchor themselves early on and follow the storyline with more clarity. I would also recommend sketches of the characters or the different races of the world— to help with the reader's imaginations a bit more but it's not a "should do" but more of an extra or bonus for the readers

Overall, I think the story has great heart — literally and figuratively. With stronger pacing, clearer structure, and a few enhancements to the setting and dialogue, it has the potential to stand out as a memorable and meaningful series that could help its readers look into their hearts as it did with me.